FREE PROMPT PACK

The Main Street AI Prompt Pack

30 copy-paste ChatGPT prompts for small businesses

Real tasks, real time saved. Every prompt is ready to paste into ChatGPT (the free version works). Swap in the parts in [brackets] and go.

- Marketing & social
- Customer service & reviews
- Sales & email
- Operations & admin
- Hiring & team
- Planning & strategy

START HERE

How to use this pack

1. Pick a prompt. Each one has a "use it when" line so you can find the right one fast.

2. Fill in the [brackets]. The more specific you are (your city, your prices, your customers), the better the answer.

3. Paste it into ChatGPT. Go to chatgpt.com. The free plan is enough for every prompt here.

4. Ask for changes. Reply with "shorter", "friendlier", "more like a text message", or "give me 3 more options". Treat it like a fast assistant, not a final answer.

5. Check before you send. Always read it over: fix facts, prices, and anything that doesn't sound like you. Don't paste in private customer data.

Want one new AI tool tip every week? You're already on the list. Follow **@ai_4mainstreet** on Instagram for daily tips.

SECTION 1 OF 6

Marketing & social

01 Post ideas for a month

Use it when you're staring at a blank calendar.

Act as a social media manager for a **[type of business]** in **[city]**. Give me 30 Instagram post ideas for **[month]**, mixing tips, behind-the-scenes, customer stories, and offers. Put them in a table with day, post idea, format (Reel, carousel, photo), and a one-line hook.

02 Turn one idea into 5 posts

Use it when you have one good idea and need a week of content.

Here is one idea for my **[type of business]**: **[idea]**. Turn it into 5 different social posts: a how-to, a myth vs. fact, a quick story, a question to my audience, and a promo. Keep each under 80 words and write in a **[friendly / bold / professional]** voice.

03 Scroll-stopping hooks

Use it when your posts get seen but not watched.

Write 10 short hooks (under 12 words) for a Reel about **[topic]** aimed at **[target customer]**. Use curiosity, a bold claim, or a common mistake. No clickbait, and no emojis.

04 Local promo blurb

Use it when you're running a deal and need it fast.

Write a short promo for **[offer, e.g. 20% off oil changes]** at **[business name]** in **[neighborhood/city]**, valid until **[date]**. Give me 3 versions: an Instagram caption, a 160-character text message, and a sign for the front window.

05 Google Business Profile post

Use it when you want to show up more in local search.

Write a Google Business Profile update for **[business name]**, a **[type of business]** in **[city]**. Topic: **[news, offer, or event]**. Use plain language, include the words **[main service]** and **[city]** naturally, and end with a clear call to action. Keep it under 150 words.

SECTION 2 OF 6

Customer service & reviews

06 Reply to a bad review

Use it when a 1- or 2-star review just landed.

Write a calm, professional reply to this review of my **[type of business]**: "**[paste review]**". Thank them, own anything we got wrong, skip excuses, and invite them to contact **[name]** at **[phone/email]** to make it right. Keep it under 90 words.

07 Thank a happy customer

Use it when you get a great review and want to reply well.

Write a warm, specific reply to this 5-star review: "**[paste review]**". Mention **[detail from the review]** and invite them back for **[upcoming offer or service]**. Under 50 words, and don't sound like a template.

08 Ask for a review

Use it when a customer just had a great experience.

Write a short, friendly text asking **[customer first name]** to leave a Google review after their **[service/purchase]**. Include this link: **[review link]**. Make it feel personal, not pushy, and under 300 characters.

09 Answer the same question faster

Use it when you type the same reply 10 times a week.

Here are the questions customers ask us most: **[list questions]**. Write a clear, friendly answer for each that I can save as a quick reply. Our details: hours **[hours]**, location **[address]**, pricing **[pricing]**, policies **[policies]**.

10 Calm an upset customer

Use it when someone is angry in your inbox or DMs.

A customer sent this message: "**[paste message]**". Write a reply that acknowledges their frustration, explains what happened in one sentence, and offers **[solution, e.g. refund, redo, discount]**. Keep it human and under 120 words.

SECTION 3 OF 6

Sales & email

11 Welcome email for new customers

Use it when someone buys from you for the first time.

Write a welcome email for new customers of **[business name]**, a **[type of business]**. Thank them, tell them what to expect next, share one useful tip about **[product/service]**, and invite them to follow us at **[social handle]**. Under 150 words.

12 Win back old customers

Use it when people who used to buy have gone quiet.

Write a short email to customers who haven't visited **[business name]** in **[time period]**. Tell them we miss them, mention what's new: **[new item or service]**, and offer **[incentive]** until **[date]**. Friendly, not desperate, under 120 words.

13 Follow up on a quote

Use it when you sent a price and heard nothing back.

Write a polite follow-up to **[customer name]** about the quote I sent on **[date]** for **[job/service]** at **[price]**. Remind them of the main benefit, answer this likely concern: **[concern]**, and give a simple next step. Under 100 words.

14 Product or service description

Use it when your website or menu copy is flat.

Write a description for **[product/service]** at **[business name]**. Who it's for: **[customer]**. What makes it different: **[details]**. Price: **[price]**. Give me a 2-sentence version and a 60-word version focused on benefits, not features.

15 Upsell without being pushy

Use it when you want bigger orders from existing buyers.

My customers usually buy **[main product/service]**. Suggest 5 natural add-ons or upgrades I could offer, and for each, write one sentence my staff can say at checkout that sounds helpful, not salesy.

SECTION 4 OF 6

Operations & admin

16 Write a simple SOP

Use it when only one person knows how to do a task.

Turn these rough notes into a step-by-step checklist a new employee can follow: **[paste notes about the task, e.g. closing the store]**. Use numbered steps, flag anything safety-related, and add a 'done right looks like' line at the end.

17 Clean up a messy email

Use it when you need to send something important and clear.

Rewrite this email so it's clear, polite, and short: "**[paste draft]**". It's going to **[vendor / landlord / customer]**. Keep my main point: **[main point]**. Give me the subject line too.

18 Plan your week

Use it when your to-do list is out of control.

Here's everything on my plate this week: **[paste list]**. I run a **[type of business]** and have about **[X]** hours for admin. Sort it into must-do, should-do, and can-wait, and suggest a day-by-day plan.

19 Negotiate with a supplier

Use it when costs went up and you want a better deal.

Write a friendly but firm email to **[supplier name]** asking for better pricing on **[product]**. We've ordered about **[amount]** per **[month/year]** for **[time]**. Mention **[competitor price or option]** if helpful and propose **[specific ask]**. Under 150 words.

20 Summarize a long document

Use it when a contract, lease, or policy is too long to read.

Summarize this document in plain English for a small business owner: **[paste text]**. List the 5 most important points, any deadlines or costs, and anything that looks risky or unusual. This is not legal advice; flag what I should ask a professional.

SECTION 5 OF 6

Hiring & team

21 Job post that attracts good people

Use it when you need to hire and the old ad isn't working.

Write a job post for a **[role]** at **[business name]** in **[city]**. Pay: **[pay range]**. Hours: **[hours]**. What the job involves: **[duties]**. Why people like working here: **[perks]**. Keep it friendly, honest, and scannable, with bullet points.

22 Interview questions

Use it when you have interviews tomorrow and no plan.

Give me 8 interview questions for a **[role]** at a **[type of business]**. Include 3 about real situations (e.g. handling a rude customer), 2 about reliability, and 3 about skills for **[key task]**. Add what a strong answer sounds like for each.

23 New hire first week

Use it when someone starts Monday.

Create a simple first-week plan for a new **[role]** at my **[type of business]**. Day by day, include what they should learn, who trains them, and one small win they can get each day. Keep it to one page.

24 Give helpful feedback

Use it when you need to talk to an employee about a problem.

Help me give feedback to **[employee role]** about **[issue, e.g. being late 3 times]**. Write what I could say in a private 5-minute talk: start with something they do well, describe the issue with facts, ask for their side, and agree on a next step.

25 Team update message

Use it when you need to share news with staff clearly.

Write a short message to my team about **[news, e.g. new holiday hours]**. Explain what's changing, when, why, and what they need to do. Positive tone, under 120 words, easy to read on a phone.

SECTION 6 OF 6

Planning & strategy

26 Find quick wins

Use it when you want more revenue without a big project.

I run a **[type of business]** in **[city]** making about **[monthly revenue]**. Our best sellers are **[items]** and our biggest problem is **[problem]**. Suggest 10 low-cost ideas I could try in the next 30 days, ranked by effort and likely impact.

27 Spy on competitors (nicely)

Use it when you want to know how to stand out.

Here's what I know about my top 3 competitors: **[names and what they offer, prices, reviews]**. Compare them to my business: **[your offer]**. Tell me where I'm stronger, where I'm weaker, and 3 ways to stand out.

28 Set simple goals

Use it when the year or quarter is starting.

Help me set 3 clear goals for my **[type of business]** for **[quarter/year]**. Where we are now: **[current numbers or situation]**. What I want: **[what you want]**. For each goal, give one number to track and 3 actions to take each month.

29 Price check

Use it when you're not sure if you're charging enough.

I sell **[product/service]** for **[price]**. My costs are about **[costs]** per sale, and competitors charge **[competitor prices]**. Help me think through whether to raise prices: pros, cons, how customers might react, and how to announce a change.

30 Plan a slow season

Use it when a quiet month is coming.

My **[type of business]** is usually slow in **[month(s)]**. Give me 10 ideas to bring in customers or cash during that time, like events, bundles, partnerships, or prepaid offers. Include a rough cost and effort for each.

RESOURCES

Free tools we use

ChatGPT

The tool behind every prompt in this pack. The free plan at chatgpt.com handles all 30.

beehiiv

The newsletter platform we use to send you these tips. Free to start, with a simple editor and built-in growth tools.
beehiiv.com/?via=zaine-kader

ElevenLabs

Realistic AI voiceovers for Reels, ads, and on-hold messages. Has a free plan to try it out.
try.elevenlabs.io/jh5ljpl2yruw

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